

User Document Rubric

Criteria	Ratings	Pts
The Basics (Minimum Requirements) Determines completeness, basic specs, and fulfillment of the user-document task. If not met, evaluation is limited strictly to this category.	75 pts Near Complete Minor baseline issue (e.g., small specification problem, limited visual component, or minor departure from the assigned user-document task). 65 pts Partially Complete Several core requirements are missing (e.g., exceeds one page, concepts do not form a coherent group, visuals play little meaningful role, or document does not function effectively as a learning aid or visual glossary). 55 pts Mostly Incomplete Major requirements are missing. Incomplete work, wrong genre, wrong audience, or submission does not meaningfully address the assigned communication task. 0 pts Meets Requirements All minimum requirements are met. Graded on remaining criteria.	75 pts
Content & Practical Usefulness Quality, relevance, accuracy, documentation, and usefulness of the information.	25 pts Meets or Exceeds Content is accurate, relevant, appropriately detailed, and useful. The document helps readers understand the concepts and apply them to workplace documents. Borrowed information and visuals are appropriately attributed and documented. 22 pts Almost There Content is generally useful and appropriate, but some information needs clarification, development, stronger practical application, or more complete documentation. 20 pts Needs Work Content is limited, underdeveloped, unclear, or focused primarily on definitions rather than application. Documentation may be incomplete or inconsistent. 0 pts Not Met Project has not met minimum requirements.	25 pts

Visual Communication Use of visuals to explain and reinforce concepts .	20 pts Meets or Exceeds Visuals and explanatory text work together effectively to help readers understand and apply the concepts . Visuals are meaningful rather than decorative, are placed near the information they support, and include appropriate labels or captions that clarify their purpose. 17 pts Almost There Visuals generally support the content, though some may be underdeveloped, loosely connected to the explanation, insufficiently labeled, or less useful than they could be. 15 pts Needs Work Visuals are limited, primarily decorative, difficult to interpret, poorly labeled, or poorly integrated with the explanatory text. 0 pts Not Met Project has not met minimum requirements.	20 pts
Document Design & Usability Design choices that help readers navigate and use the document quickly.	20 pts Meets or Exceeds Design effectively applies contrast, repetition, alignment, proximity, and white space to create a clear visual hierarchy. Related content is grouped together, text is appropriately chunked and aligned, and typography is readable. The page is easy to scan and use as a quick reference. 17 pts Almost There Design is generally effective and usable, with minor problems involving hierarchy, spacing, alignment, proximity, consistency, typography, or scanability. 15 pts Needs Work Recurring design problems make information harder to locate or use. Weak hierarchy, dense text, inconsistent alignment or spacing, poor proximity, or other design choices interfere with readability. 0 pts Not Met Project has not met minimum requirements.	20 pts
Audience & Reader-Centered Communication Effectiveness for non-expert employees using the document as a workplace quick reference.	15 pts Meets or Exceeds Content, explanations, examples, and presentation are clearly tailored to non-expert employees using the document as a workplace quick reference. The document anticipates what readers need to understand or do. 13 pts Almost There Audience awareness is generally effective, but some explanations, examples, or choices could better support non-expert readers. 11 pts Needs Work The document assumes too much knowledge, provides insufficient guidance, or does not consistently address readers’ needs. 0 pts Not Met Project has not met minimum requirements.	15 pts

Clarity & Plain Language Readable, concise, accessible explanation of concepts.	12 pts Meets or Exceeds Writing is concise, concrete, reader-friendly, and easy to understand. Jargon is avoided or clearly explained. Information is effectively chunked into manageable units. 10 pts Almost There Writing is generally clear and concise, with occasional problems involving wording, jargon, density, or readability. 9 pts Needs Work Recurring problems with wordiness, jargon, vague language, dense text, or complicated sentences interfere with understanding. 0 pts Not Met Project has not met minimum requirements.	12 pts
Accessibility Design choices that support readability and access for different users.	8 pts Meets or Exceeds Typography, font size, alignment, color contrast, and visual presentation support accessibility and readability. Text is easy to read, and information does not depend unnecessarily on color or visuals alone. 7 pts Almost There Document is generally accessible and readable, with minor accessibility issues. 6 pts Needs Work Recurring problems with font size, alignment, contrast, typography, or visual presentation may make the document difficult for some readers to use. 0 pts Not Met Project has not met minimum requirements.	8 pts